



Solid shot

A memento of the Battle of Hampton Roads—a solid shot flattened on striking CSS *Virginia*'s sloping ironplate armor. The *Virginia* remained known to the Union side by its original name, *Merrimack*.

USS Monitor enters the fray

The next morning, the *Virginia* reappeared, with Lieutenant Catesby ap Roger Jones commanding in place of the wounded Buchanan. Jones was puzzled to see a strange low-lying metal object between the *Virginia* and the stranded *Minnesota*. This was the Union ironclad USS *Monitor*. Towed south from New York in great haste, it had taken up position during the night. The *Monitor* had undergone a hair-raising voyage, nearly sinking in heavy seas. Its crew of 59